

Portsmouth and the Housing 2030 goal

Housing 2030 growth category: Continued · goal 172 homes permitted 2026–2030 (26 affordable), about 34 a year

34	91	56	5
homes a year the goal asks for	permitted in 2025, by the State's survey (268% of the yearly pace)	permitted in 2025, by the town's reports to the Census (165%)	certificates of occupancy in 2025, by the State's survey

The goal is written in permits, and the State has not said which count will measure it. For Portsmouth the two counts agreed in 3 of the last eight years.

NEW HOMES PERMITTED, TWO GOVERNMENT COUNTS

Year	Census Building Permits Survey	State municipal survey	Same?
2018	26	26	yes
2019	30	30	yes
2020	29*	28	
2021	35*	35	yes
2022	27	53	
2023	22*	54	
2024	117	123	
2025	56	91	

WHAT THE QUARTERLY UPDATE ADDS

Each quarter: the latest Census months against the pace the goal requires, the State's numbers when they publish, and, where the town shares its permit log, a permit-by-permit reconciliation of the two counts, so the number the town reports is the number it can defend.

Sources: U.S. Census Bureau Building Permits Survey, annual place files (* fewer than 12 months reported; includes the Bureau's estimate). State: HousingWorks RI Housing Fact Books 2019–2024 (each reports the prior year; accessory dwelling units not counted), RI Department of Housing 2024 Integrated Housing Report Fig. 2.3, RI Executive Office of Housing 2025 Integrated Housing Report Figs. 2.1, 2.3, 2.4. Goals: housing.ri.gov/media/3401. Every town and year: providenceontherecord.org/housing · Liam Freaney · lfreaney@gmail.com · 347-419-7395